

Shashank Pokala

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SUMMARY

Data Analyst with 4+ years of experience transforming complex datasets into actionable insights, driving measurable growth across finance and SaaS sectors. Proficient in SQL, Snowflake, and Power BI, with expertise in building scalable, self-service dashboards and optimizing ETL workflows. Demonstrated success in developing experimental frameworks and data visualizations that enable evidence-based decision-making and performance optimization. Adept at collaborating with cross-functional teams to align analytical systems with strategic marketing and growth goals.

SKILLS

- **Data Analytics & Visualization:** Power BI (DAX, Power Query), Tableau, A/B Testing, Excel, SQL, Google Analytics, Alteryx, Marketing Analytics, Experimentation Frameworks
- **Programming & Scripting:** SQL (CTEs, Joins, Window Functions), Python (Pandas, NumPy), REST APIs
- **ETL & Data Integration:** Snowflake, AWS (S3, Athena, EMR), PySpark, Power Query, Macros
- **AI & Automation:** ChatGPT, Gemini, GenAI-powered natural language querying
- **Project & Collaboration Tools:** Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Git, Agile (Scrum)
- **Database & Modeling:** MySQL Server, Snowflake, Database Design, Data Modeling, Analytical Systems
- **Methodologies:** SDLC, Agile, UAT Testing, Stakeholder Reporting

EXPERIENCE

Falcon Papers and Plastics

Jul 2024 - Present

Data Analyst

Remote

- Automated financial reporting by developing interactive dashboards in Power BI (DAX, Power Query) connected to SQL Server, reducing manual reporting efforts by 40% and enabling faster performance insights.
- Improved forecasting accuracy by 25% through building and optimizing ETL pipelines in Snowflake that consolidated financial data from Excel, ERP systems, and external sources, establishing a solid data foundation for decision-making.
- Accelerated scenario modeling by 30% by integrating GenAI tools (OpenAI, Gemini) into financial analysis workflows, supporting rapid, data-driven decision-making.
- Collaborated with FP&A teams to define, track, and analyze OPEX/CAPEX ratios, variance trends, and client profitability KPIs, aligning analytical insights with strategic planning.
- Enhanced self-service analytics for non-technical users by embedding natural language querying and drill-through capabilities into BI dashboards to promote evidence-based decision-making.
- Delivered board-ready financial reports, quarterly presentations, and executive decks using Excel and PowerPoint, ensuring that insights were clearly communicated to guide strategic initiatives.
- Conducted in-depth financial anomaly detection and audit support using Python (Pandas, NumPy) and advanced SQL queries (joins, CTEs, window functions), ensuring data integrity and compliance.

ZS Associates Pvt. Ltd

Mar 2021 - Dec 2022

Business Technology Solutions Associate

Pune, India

- Enhanced KPI visibility by 20% through the development and deployment of 15+ interactive dashboards in Power BI and Tableau, facilitating measurable marketing analytics and performance tracking.
- Optimized ETL workflows using AWS S3, Athena, and EMR to build scalable data foundations that support robust analytical systems.
- Queried and analyzed large-scale healthcare and logistics datasets using SQL and Python to uncover actionable insights that informed campaign strategies.
- Ensured a 95% defect-free delivery rate by leading comprehensive UAT across 30+ user stories for analytics modules, strengthening the overall data quality.
- Improved sprint efficiency by 15% through proactive Jira backlog grooming and Agile sprint planning, supporting a culture of evidence-based decision-making.
- Implemented an AI-powered “Next Best Thing” recommendation engine to drive data-informed sales and marketing strategies.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to align dashboard metrics with business goals and empower self-service reporting.
- Leveraged client-provided flat files to generate marketing campaign insights using Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC), supporting growth measurement frameworks.

Arthashastra Intelligence Databases Private Limited

Nov 2019 - Nov 2020

Data Insights Analyst

Hyderabad, India

- Enhanced strategic reporting accuracy by 15% by optimizing SQL models aligned with financial KPIs, strengthening the data foundation for performance analysis.
- Analyzed 10M+ rows of economic and trade data using SQL, delivering insights that influenced national policy recommendations and informed growth strategies.
- Integrated and cleaned data from APIs, CSVs, and internal pipelines to create scalable data foundations that support cross-channel analytical systems.

- Delivered market and financial risk assessments using Excel and SQL, underpinning enhanced risk management strategies and marketing analytics.
- Defined and implemented key performance indicators (KPIs) in collaboration with stakeholders, ensuring alignment with data-driven decision-making processes.
- Optimized Agile workflows by managing JIRA-based project execution, improving sprint visibility and timely delivery of analytics projects.

EDUCATION

Saint Louis University – St. Louis, MO

Jan 2023 - May 2024

Master of Science, Information Systems

Saint Louis, MO

- **GPA:** 3.94
- **Coursework:** Data Analysis, Business Intelligence, Advanced SQL

Lovely Professional University (LPU) – Phagwara, India

Aug 2017 - Aug 2021

Bachelor of Technology (Honors), Electronics and Communication Engineering

- **GPA:** 7.29/10
- **Achievements:** Project: Designed an IoT-based Earthquake Alert System, published in JETIR for its real-time seismic response algorithm

CERTIFICATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- **Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate (PL-300):** Issued May 2024
- **Salesforce Certified Administrator:** Issued Apr 2023
- **Snowflake Hands-On Essentials: Data Warehouse:** Completed Mar 2024
- **Deloitte Australia: Data Analytics Virtual Experience:** Forage, Mar 2025
- **Tata: Data Visualization & Storytelling Virtual Program:** Forage, Mar 2025